

Bedtime Tales

The Puddle Mirror

KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



After the rain stopped, the street was full of puddles, and little Zinnia pulled on her yellow boots. Splish, splash, went her boots on the wet road, and her heart bubbled with joy.

Then she found it — the biggest puddle of all, round and smooth as a dinner plate. Zinnia bent down to look. "Oh!" she gasped. There she was, smiling right back at her from the water. "Hello, me," she giggled, feeling gloriously silly.



Then she looked closer, and her giggle melted into wonder. The sky was down there too — and a fluffy cloud, and the very top of the Old Apple Tree. "The puddle is a mirror," she breathed. "A mirror, a mirror, a mirror," she chanted softly — three times, because it felt too wonderful to say just once. Wonder filled her up like a balloon.



Zinnia had an idea. She lay on her tummy at the puddle's edge, careful not to get her sleeves wet, and watched the cloud sail across the puddle sky. "Where are you going, cloud?" she whispered. The cloud never answered — it only floated on, slow and white.



Then a bird flew overhead, and Zinnia saw it in the puddle first. A real bird, flying in the puddle sky! Surprise and delight fizzed through her all at once. "Look, Mama!" she called. "There is a whole sky down here!"



Mama came to look. "You are right," she said. "A tiny sky, just for you."



Zinnia pulled a face at her puddle self, and her puddle self pulled one right back. She stuck out her tongue, and so did it. Giggles ran through her like bubbles.



Then the sun came out in full, and the puddle began to shrink. "Where is it going?" Zinnia asked, and a little ache tugged at her chest. "Back up to the sky," said Mama, "to become a cloud again."



Zinnia waved at the puddle. "Goodbye, mirror," she whispered. "Goodbye, goodbye, goodbye" — three times, one for every face she had pulled. Peace settled over her like a soft blanket.



That night, Zinnia looked out her window and wondered if her puddle was a cloud now, floating somewhere far above the rooftops. She dreamed of tiny skies in silver puddles.



Sleep now, little Zinnia.

Sleep now, little Zinnia.

The End

